

14.1 Vectors and Lists

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1. Two kinds of vectors

R has two kinds of vectors: **atomic** vectors and **lists**.

An atomic vector holds one type: logical, integer, double, character (plus complex and raw, which we will not use). A list can hold mixed types, including other lists.

```
x <- c(1L, 10L, 2L)
typeof(x)
length(x)
```

c(1, 10, 2) is double. The L makes an integer. typeof() is the storage type. length() is how many elements.

A factor is an integer with labels. A Date is a double. Both still behave like atomic vectors when you subset them.

2. [keeps structure; [[extracts one

[returns the same kind of object, names included. [[pulls out **one** element and drops the wrapper. \$ is [[for a name.

```
x <- c(horse = 7, man = 1, dog = 8)
x[2:3]
x[c("man", "horse")]
x[-3]
x[[3]]
```

x[3] is still a named vector of length 1. x[[3]] is the number 8.

A logical vector of the same length picks the TRUE positions:

```
x[c(TRUE, FALSE, TRUE)]
```

3. Recycling and names

R recycles a shorter vector to the length of the longer one:

```
x <- c(1, 2, 3, 4)
x + 10
# same idea as x + c(10, 10, 10, 10)
```

Recycling a non-scalar (`x + c(10, 20)`) is legal and easy to misread. Prefer a scalar, or write a vector of the same length.

`names(x)` is a character vector. You can set names when you create the object:

```
c(Yoshi = 10L, Mario = 31L)
```

4. Lists hold mixed types

```
my_list <- list(
  x = "a",
  y = 1,
  z = c(1L, 2L, 3L)
)
```

`[` on a list returns a **list**. `[[` or `$` returns the element inside.

```
my_list[1]
my_list[[1]]
my_list$y
```

Remove an element by assigning `NULL` :

```
my_list$x <- NULL
```

5. A data frame is a list of columns

A tibble is a list. Each element is a column. That is why `df[[2]]` is the second column and `df$species` is the `species` column.

A list can also hold a tibble as one of its elements. Subset the list to get the tibble; then use `dplyr` on that tibble.

6. Practice

1. Create

```
x <- c(  
  Yoshi = 10L,  
  Mario = 31L,  
  Luigi = 72L,  
  Peach = 11L,  
  Toad  = 38L  
)
```

Extract Yoshi and Peach four ways: positive integers, negative integers, a logical vector, and names.

2. Build a wedding-style list: a `venue`, a `guest` tibble (name, meal, age), a `bride`, a `groom`, and a `date`. Remove one guest row from the embedded tibble. Add a named vector that decodes the meal codes. Extract the venue two ways.